US History · Unit 1 · Level 2 (modified)

Timeline & Political Cartoons



TODAY'S PLAN

- 🗓️ Timeline of US History
- 📅 Putting events in order
- 🖼️ What is a political cartoon?
- 🔍 BASIC: 5 steps to read a cartoon

Review · 5 minutes

Quick Review



🇺🇸 US History is the story of our country, from the past to today.

📅 Every event has a **date**. Dates help us put events in **order**.

🤔 Quick think: name one important event you know.

Words to Know

Words to Know



Timeline

A line that shows events in the order they happened, with dates.



Event

Something important that happened at one time.



Date

The day or year something happened.



Political cartoon

A drawing about news or government that shows the artist's opinion.

Words to Know

More Words to Know



🧠 **Background**: Facts you need to know first to understand a cartoon (the B in BASIC).

💬 **Argument**: The point the cartoonist wants you to believe (the A in BASIC).

🦅 **Symbol**: A picture that stands for something bigger, like Uncle Sam for the USA (the S in BASIC).

🔤 **Indicator**: Words, labels or captions that tell you who or what is in the cartoon (the I in BASIC).

Learn

What Is a Timeline?



A **timeline** shows events in the order they happened.

Older events come first. Newer events come last.

The class guesses dates, then checks them on the timeline slides.

Compare

Older and Newer



Older

1865: Civil War ends
1876: Battle of Little Bighorn
1903: first airplane

Newer

1941: Pearl Harbor is attacked
1969: Moon landing
2008: first African American president elected

🃏 Check 1 of 4



Which event happened first?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Women win the vote (1920)

2️⃣ Civil War ends (1865)

3️⃣ Moon landing (1969)



Civil War ends (1865)

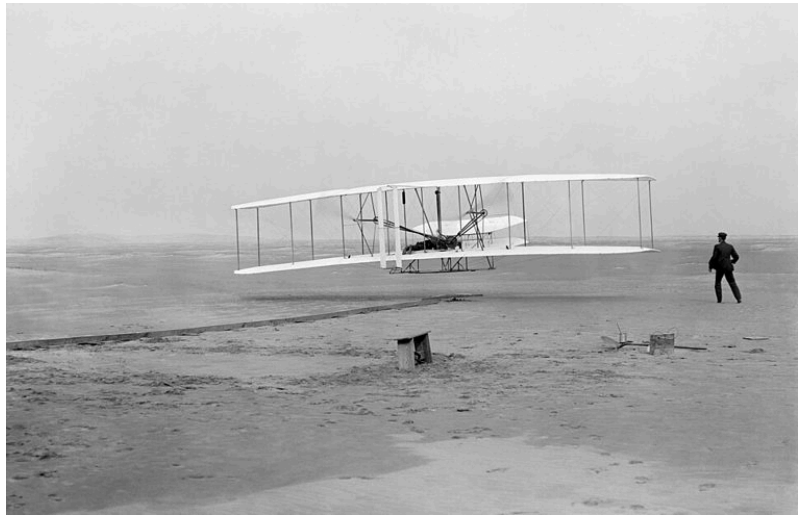
1865 is the oldest date.

Learn

First Flight, 1903

The **Wright brothers** made the first airplane flight in **1903**.

It lasted 12 seconds!



Learn

Events We Study This Year



1865
Civil War ends



1920
women win the vote

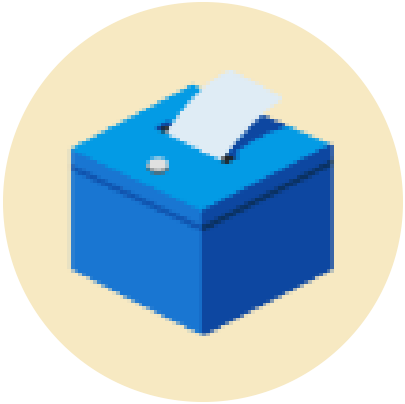


1929
stock market crashes



1969
Moon landing

🃏 Check 2 of 4



What year did women win the right to vote?

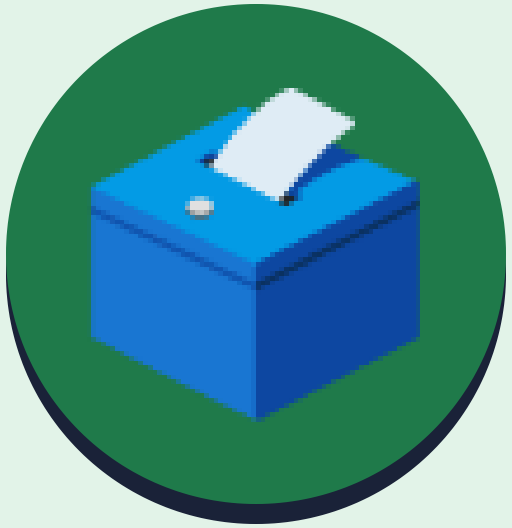
Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ 1865

2️⃣ 2008

3️⃣ 1920

✅ Answer · Card 2 of 4



1920

The 19th Amendment passed in 1920.

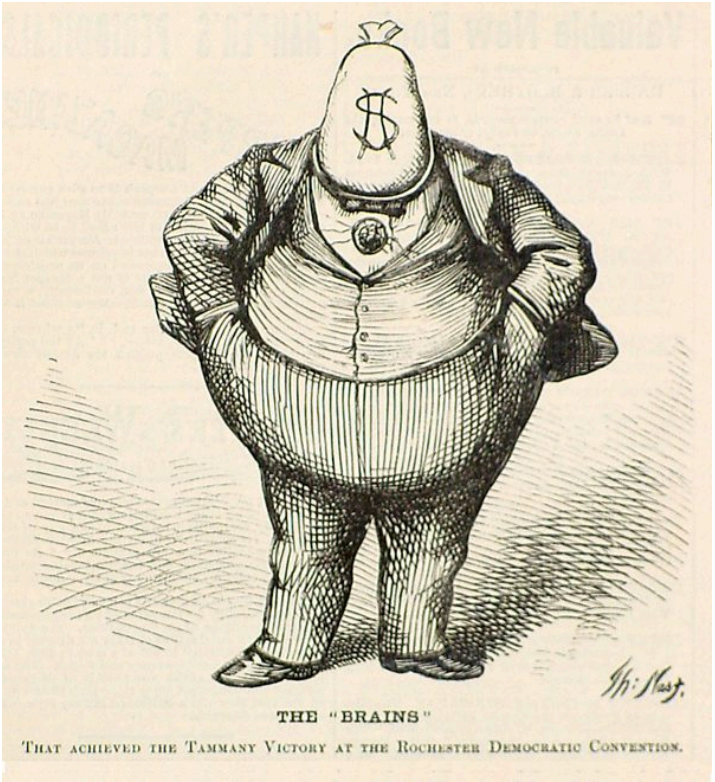
Learn

Political Cartoons

A **political cartoon** is a drawing about news or government.

It shows the artist's **opinion**.

In this 1871 cartoon, Thomas Nast drew a politician with a **money bag** for a head.



Steps

BASIC: Read a Cartoon



1. **B**ackground: What do I already know?
2. **A**rgument: What does the artist want me to believe?
3. **S**ymbols: What do the pictures stand for?
4. **I**ndicators: What do the words and labels say?
5. **C**aricature: What is drawn too big?

🃏 Check 3 of 4



In BASIC, the A stands for…

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Argument: the artist's message

2️⃣ Animal

3️⃣ Answer key



Argument: the artist's message

The argument is the point the artist is making.

Learn

Uncle Sam: A Symbol

Uncle Sam is a symbol for the **United States**.

You will see him in many cartoons this year.

This poster is from World War I (1917).



🃏 Check 4 of 4



Why do cartoonists use symbols?

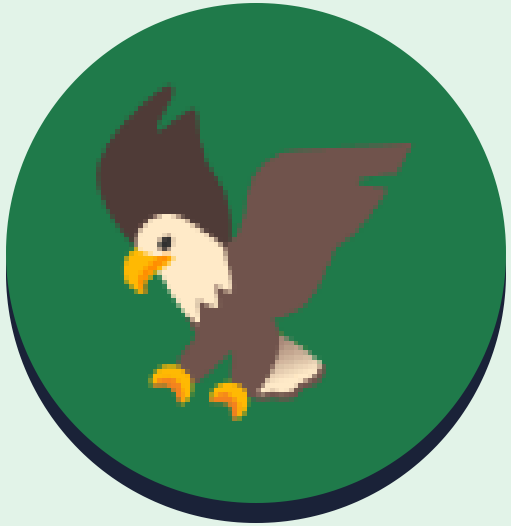
Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ To fill empty space

2️⃣ To show the date

3️⃣ A picture can stand for a big idea

✅ Answer · Card 4 of 4



A picture can stand for a big idea

Symbols are a quick way to show a big idea.

Wrap-Up

Recap



Timeline
events in order



Cartoon
drawing + opinion



BASIC
5 steps



Uncle Sam
symbol of the USA

Wrap-Up

Exit Ticket



Name 1 event and its year.

What does BASIC stand for?

What is a symbol? Give an example.